

Terraform Interview Preparation – Important Topics

If you want to crack DevOps, Cloud, or Terraform interviews, focus strongly on these Terraform concepts.

Must Know Terraform Topics

Terraform Basics

- Infrastructure as Code (IaC)
 - Declarative vs Imperative
 - Terraform Workflow
 - Terraform Architecture
 - Providers & Resources
-

Core Terraform Commands

- terraform init
 - terraform plan
 - terraform apply
 - terraform destroy
 - terraform validate
 - terraform fmt
 - terraform refresh
-

MOST IMPORTANT TOPICS

Terraform State File

- terraform.tfstate
 - terraform.tfstate.backup
 - Remote Backend
 - State Locking
 - Blob Lease
 - Drift Detection
 - State Migration
-

Meta Arguments

- count
 - for_each
 - depends_on
 - lifecycle
 - provider
 - create_before_destroy
 - prevent_destroy
 - ignore_changes
-

Variables & Outputs

- variables.tf
 - terraform.tfvars
 - sensitive variables
 - output values
 - local variables
-

Modules

- Reusable Infrastructure
 - Child Modules
 - Root Modules
 - Module Inputs & Outputs
 - Terraform Registry
-

Terraform Functions

- file()
 - lookup()
 - element()
 - length()
 - join()
 - split()
 - format()
 - tostring()
-

Provisioners

- local-exec

- remote-exec
 - null_resource
-

Terraform with Azure

- Resource Groups
 - VNET
 - Subnets
 - NSG
 - VM
 - Storage Account
 - App Service
 - AKS Basics
-

Terraform CI/CD

- Terraform in Azure Pipelines
 - Terraform in GitHub Actions
 - Pipeline Stages
 - Plan & Apply Flow
 - Approval Process
 - Backend Configuration
-

Interview-Focused Concepts

- count vs for_each
 - State File Importance
 - Why Remote Backend?
 - What is Drift?
 - Why Declarative IaC?
 - What is Blob Lease?
 - Why create_before_destroy?
 - How Terraform handles dependencies?
 - What happens during terraform apply?
 - Difference between local and remote backend
-

Strong Recommendation

Do hands-on practice on:

- VM deployment
- Web App deployment
- Remote backend setup
- Modules
- CI/CD integration

because interviewers ask mostly practical questions.

Final Advice

If you understand:

- State File
- Meta Arguments
- Modules
- Remote Backend
- CI/CD Integration

You are already ahead of many Terraform beginners.